DEBO ODULANA

Dr Jubril Adebowale Odulana / MBBS, MSc / Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria, full registration

Healthcare chief executive / health system delivery and private sector mobilisation / founding partner, Consult for Africa

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PROFILE

Physician and operator, sixteen years in hospital leadership, health system strategy and healthcare venture building across Africa, the Middle East and the UK. I took a 75-bed Abuja surgical hospital to the strongest financial year in its sixteen-year history, reset the clinical workforce economics of a fund-owned tertiary network without losing volume, and built a 21-state private healthcare network that was acquired by the market leader.

The work outside those P&Ls is the same work. I have built primary care that had to pay for itself in a riverine community the road does not reach, stood up a 90-bed public field hospital in six weeks with Lagos State, and I lead the Doctors Foundation for Care, a body of more than 800 diaspora-trained Nigerian physicians whose secretariat and governance I built from nothing.

I run Consult for Africa, a healthcare advisory and venture firm that takes build and operate mandates rather than reports, so the plans we write come back to us as a number to hit.

What I am good at is the part after the launch: making a health facility stand up economically and keep reaching people once the opening budget has been spent.

SELECTED RESULTS

- **A 21-state provider network built from nothing and sold.** Doctoora reached that spread without building a single facility, by monetising clinic and hospital capacity that already existed and was sitting idle. Acquired by Evercare Hospital Lekki.
- **Community health models reaching more than 6,000 households**, including a subscription primary care service in a hard to reach riverine community and a clinic for 5,000 traders built with their own trade association. Both were designed to survive their own launch.
- **A 90-bed public field hospital inside six weeks** at the Eti-Osa COVID-19 isolation centre, including a 10-bed ICU with remote monitoring and the state-wide dashboard that connected every Lagos isolation centre into government reporting.
- **N1.0bn+ monthly revenue and N1bn+ EBITDA in H1** at Cedarcrest Abuja, the strongest performance in the hospital's sixteen-year history and ahead of the whole of the prior year.
- **$1.1M annualised cost out** at Evercare Lekki, through clinical workforce and service portfolio rebalancing, with volume held.
- **23% revenue growth in three months** from a consultant pay-for-performance model that raised variable pay 15% at the same time. Clinicians backed it because they were paid for it.
- **An asset-light expansion model** designed and adopted at Evercare, under which the hospital takes over the management of existing facilities with no capital expenditure. Management, not capital, was the scarce input. It opened new Lagos sites.
- **More than N2bn of planned annual revenue** underwritten since founding Consult for Africa, across a medical campus development, a paediatric and neonatal hospital, a specialist surgical group, a day case facility and an HMO network.

SECTOR LEADERSHIP, POLICY AND CONVENING

- **Member**, Nigerian Economic Summit Group Health Policy Commission. Health as a business, and public health reform.
- **Lead, Programme and Content Planning**, Healthcare Federation of Nigeria. Authored the federation's policy brief to the Minister of State for Health on the house officer placement bottleneck, written for adoption in the federation's own voice.
- **Independent Non-Executive Director**, Havana Specialist Hospital, Lagos. Structuring a two-family shareholder board under a partnership with a regional operator, with fair process as the source of its legitimacy.
- **Winner**, Nigerian Economic Summit Group 25th Anniversary Startup Pitch, 2019.

EXPERIENCE

Consult for Africa

Nov 2025 – Present

Founding Partner

Healthcare advisory and venture firm. Strategy, operating turnarounds, board work and build and operate mandates for hospital groups, specialist practices, HMOs and owners.

- Built the firm from nothing to a live portfolio: a multi-business medical campus, a paediatric and neonatal hospital turnaround, an orthopaedic surgical group, a takaful HMO network strategy, a day case cancer and surgical facility, and a multi-sector family holding company.

- Structured and costed a **N1.7bn medical campus** in Abuja: measured geometry, rent roll, a twelve-business operating model, a monthly cash model, peak funding of N718M and a 29-month payback. The model, not the brief, is the authority on timing.
- Ran a full organisational and financial audit of a paediatric and neonatal hospital, then wrote the growth plan behind it: **N45 to N50M monthly revenue at 18 to 20% EBITDA inside six months**, NICU led, funded by a tariff reset in two tranches.
- Price build and operate mandates so that the incentive is subordinated to the client's return of capital: a lower share until the money is home, a higher one after. Owners sign it because the downside is ours too.
- Carry the operating result on mandates where Consult for Africa installs and manages the team, not only the plan.

Doctors Foundation for Care

Apr 2025 – Present

President

Nonprofit membership body of more than 800 diaspora-trained Nigerian physicians, working on capacity building and contributory practice at home.

- Built the Secretariat and the governance structures from nothing, and the operating calendar the Foundation now runs on.
- Grew membership 10% and led the digital platform that launched in January 2026, which gives members a structured route to contribute clinically without relocating.
- Turned the brain drain argument into a contributory one. What is offered to members is episodic, organised service rather than a permanent return, because that is the version people actually say yes to.
- Represent the Foundation in sector forums on workforce, training capacity and the terms on which diaspora clinicians will engage with Nigerian institutions.

Mezo Health

Mar 2026 – Present

Founder (a Consult for Africa venture)

Verified specialist network and hospital operating stack.

- The Doctoora thesis rebuilt with the layer it was missing. The platform fills the clinic, runs the schedule, processes the HMO claim and collects the money, so a specialist can run a private practice without building one.
- **Asset-light capacity monetisation.** Facility, room and visit-block contracting lets a hospital sell idle clinical capacity by the session instead of carrying it as fixed cost.
- **A working capital product** at the centre of it: advance factoring of up to 80% on pending HMO claims. Receivables, not demand, are what actually cap private practice growth in this market.
- Sits on a verified workforce registry of more than 10,000 Nigerian clinicians, built and maintained in house.

Cedarcrest Hospitals Abuja

Oct 2024 – Nov 2025

Chief Executive Officer

75-bed tertiary surgical hospital and the largest revenue contributor within Cedarcrest Hospitals Ltd.

- **Financial turnaround.** N1.0bn+ monthly revenue by October 2025, the highest in the hospital's history, and N1bn+ EBITDA in H1, surpassing the full prior year.
- **Commercial reset.** Tariffs realigned to the market, service mix rebalanced, revenue governance and leakage controls installed.
- **People and structure.** Leadership cut from 20 roles to 8, the consultant compensation framework rewritten, revenue-based variable pay introduced for full time consultants, psychological safety and engagement measurably improved.
- **Growth.** Built digital referral systems and B2B partnerships, stood up commercial and digital innovation functions, redesigned patient acquisition.
- **Operations.** Enterprise-wide process controls and service reliability frameworks.

Evercare Hospital Lekki

Mar 2023 – Oct 2024

Chief Innovation and Strategy Officer

165-bed tertiary hospital inside Evercare's fund-owned Africa and South Asia network.

- Delivered **$1.1M in annualised savings** through clinical workforce and service portfolio optimisation.
- Designed and implemented the **doctor pay-for-performance model**: revenue up 23% in three months, variable pay up 15%.
- Developed **Evercare Advantage**, a capital-free network expansion model under which the hospital takes over the management of existing facilities. Used to open new Lagos outreach branches.
- Authored the two-year digital transformation roadmap for Evercare Nigeria and Pakistan, covering EMR optimisation, the digital front door and remote care pathways.
- Launched telemedicine, homecare, digital sales channels and outreach, with the referral workflows and partnerships that fed specialist volume.

Doctoora Health

Dec 2016 – Mar 2023

Founder and Chief Executive Officer

Nigeria's first technology-enabled private healthcare network. Acquired by Evercare Hospital Lekki.

- Built and bootstrapped a distributed provider network across **21 states**, monetising underused clinic and hospital capacity on an as-needed basis.
- Designed community health models reaching more than **6,000 households**, including a subscription primary care service in a hard to reach riverine community and a clinic for 5,000 traders built with a trade association.
- Ran the whole company: operations, clinical governance, technology and finance across multisite services, with a team of eleven through market entry.
- Positioned the business for acquisition and sold it to Evercare Hospital Lekki.

House of Refuge, Lagos

Jun 2024 – Present

Adviser: Strategy, Fundraising and Management Support

A Freedom Foundation project. Specialist addiction rehabilitation network, founding stage.

- Financial model, operating plan and organisational design for a 10-bed pilot centre in Lekki, with the scale framework and investment roadmap to **120 beds across four sites by 2027**.
- Wrote the investment and fundraising case, and hold the fundraising mandate on a contingent basis, so the Foundation pays for money raised rather than for advice.
- Service model, pricing, clinical and service workflows, staffing and governance.
- Now run ongoing management support for the facility on a monthly retainer.

Cooked Indoors Medical Nutrition

Nov 2022 – Present

Founder

Clinical nutrition platform for hospitals, HMOs, pharmacies and patients.

- Built a personalised food as medicine platform and a clinical recipe library of more than 1,000 condition-specific recipes.
- Hired a chief executive in October 2024 and stepped back to a non-executive role. The company trades without me in it, which was the point.

EARLIER CAREER

- **Chief Information Officer**, Eti-Osa COVID-19 Isolation and Treatment Centre, Lagos Apr 2020 – Jul 2020
  Full technology strategy for a 90-bed field hospital inside six weeks, including a 10-bed ICU with remote patient monitoring, a customised HMIS and the state-wide reporting dashboard that connected every Lagos isolation centre. A public private build, under emergency conditions, with the state as the counterparty.
- **Consultant, Care Model Design**, Lifeplan Hospital, now Evercare Hospital Lagos Mar 2017 – Jul 2017
  Care models for a 350-bed teaching hospital, a 165-bed multispecialty hospital and 60 community clinics, and the operating process for phase one in Lekki.
- **Business Development Executive**, SynbiCITE, United Kingdom Nov 2016 – Jan 2017
  Compiled the first UK synthetic biology start-up annual report and ran the Bio-Start accelerator campaign, which lifted applicants 60% in the first month.
- **Engagement Manager**, Imperial Consulting Group, United Kingdom Feb 2016 – Sep 2016
  Led a team of eight on business planning and market entry for a technology start-up, and wrote the launch strategy and pricing case for a consumer electronics device.
- **Interim Process Improvement Consultant**, Hammersmith Hospital, Imperial College Healthcare NHS Trust Jun 2016 – Aug 2016
  Lean implementation in haematology outpatients: value stream mapping, bottleneck diagnosis, benchmarking, and a recommendation set worth 5% quickly and a further 10 to 15% over a year.
- **Surgical Team Lead and Lead Quality Champion**, St Nicholas Hospital, Lagos May 2014 – Sep 2015
  Led Nigeria's first electronic patient record implementation, 30% of a GBP 1.8M expansion programme across four sites, prepared the hospital for COHSASA accreditation, and ran the surgical team and junior doctor training.
- **Medical Officer and Chief Medical Officer**, General Hospital Moniya and NYSC Camp Clinic, Oyo State 2013 – 2014
  Acute and surgical services to a rural catchment of 250,000, and camp clinic operations for 5,000 with zero mortality.
- **House Officer**, Lagos State University Teaching Hospital Nov 2011 – Dec 2012
  Core rotations across surgery, medicine, paediatrics and obstetrics.
- **Professional Education Consultant, DEPAT**, DePuy Orthopaedics, Johnson and Johnson, UAE Dec 2010 – Oct 2011
  Surgeon and theatre nurse training programmes across the Middle East and Africa, and 150 new sales leads from the Sharjah Surgical Institute in a year.

EDUCATION

- **MSc, International Health Management** Imperial College Business School, London, 2016 Student-Staff Committee Chair, Dean's Student Advisory Council, founder of the Africa Business Club
- **MBBS, Medicine and Surgery** University of Sharjah, United Arab Emirates, 2011

WHAT I BRING

Strategy and organisational leadership Multi-site P&L ownership, organisational design, executive team building, board and shareholder reporting, governance and internal control, culture and psychological safety.

Partnerships, advocacy and convening Corporate, government and development sector relationships, high-level negotiation, policy authorship, sector representation and spokesperson work, board-level persuasion in Nigerian boardrooms.

Resource mobilisation and financial stewardship Financial modelling and underwriting, feasibility and investment cases, capital expenditure planning, contingent fundraising mandates, budgeting and reporting discipline, one founder-side exit.

Programme design and delivery Primary and community care models, facility revitalisation and management takeover, clinical governance, quality accreditation, measurement and reporting, HIS and HMIS, digital front door and referral systems, Power BI and Tableau.

Honours Winner, Nigerian Economic Summit Group 25th Anniversary Startup Pitch, 2019 / Global Action on Poverty Changemaker Award, 2016 / Founder, Africa Business Club, Imperial College Business School. **Languages** English and Yoruba, native. Arabic, basic.